

and don't know everything: you may need to alert them to a major school project, a class registration or scholarship application deadline, unsecured guns in a neighbor's house, or drug possession.

13. Bring extra to share or just share whether you have extra or not.

You might bring extra water, Clif bars, or salty nuts on a hiking trip, or a spare tube and CO₂ pump on a bike ride. Being prepared is great; being prepared *and* understanding is even better. (This one may cost you more than nothing, but not by much.)

— Julie Rains



10 Tips for Winning College Scholarships

Winning a scholarship takes effort, even to snag an award that is relatively small (\$500–\$1,000) compared to the cost of attendance at a state uni-

versity (can be more than \$16,000 per year). But if you can acquire multiple awards (which is easier once you land the first scholarship), you can rack up big savings. Sorting through the volume of information on scholarships can be overwhelming, though. Here are a few tips from professionals.

I spoke with Kimberly Stezala, author of *Scholarships 101: The Real-World Guide to Getting Cash for College*, and Betty Wagner, who works in academic advising at Central Michigan University (CMU). Kimberly educated me on private scholarships and Betty filled me in on university-specific awards. They both gave great tips on winning college scholarships.

1. Start early

Kimberly recommends exploring scholarship opportunities at least by the summer before your senior year of high school. Betty recommends visiting college campuses and narrowing your choices in the summer before your junior year based on factors such as admission criteria, cost, and programs of study.

2. Take advanced-level English classes

This can help boost your high school transcript and equip you with the